



Instagram-like Social Media Database

BCNF Normalization Proof Report

"USERS" Relation:

USERS(user_id, username, email, password_hash, created_at, is_verified, type_id)

FDs:

$\{user_id\} \rightarrow \{username, email, password_hash, created_at, is_verified, type_id\}$

Closure of {user_id}:

$\{user_id\}^+ = \{user_id, username, email, password_hash, created_at, is_verified, type_id\}$

Closure of {user_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "USERS".
Thus {user_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {user_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "USERS" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"ACCOUNT_TYPES" Relation:

ACCOUNT_TYPES(type_id, type_name)

FDs:

$\{type_id\} \rightarrow \{type_name\}$

Closure of {type_id}:

$\{type_id\}^+ = \{type_id, type_name\}$

Closure of {type_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "ACCOUNT_TYPES".
Thus {type_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {type_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "ACCOUNT_TYPES" is a Super Key.

Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"FOLLOWERS" Relation:

FOLLOWERS(follower_id, following_id, created_at)

FDs:

$\{ \text{follower_id}, \text{following_id} \} \rightarrow \{ \text{created_at} \}$

Closure of {follower_id, following_id}:

$\{ \text{follower_id}, \text{following_id} \}^+ = \{ \text{follower_id}, \text{following_id}, \text{created_at} \}$

Closure of {follower_id, following_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "FOLLOWERS".
Thus {follower_id, following_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {follower_id, following_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "FOLLOWERS" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"BLOCKED_ACCOUNTS" Relation:

BLOCKED_ACCOUNTS(blocker_id, blocked_id, block_date)

FDs:

$\{ \text{blocker_id}, \text{blocked_id} \} \rightarrow \{ \text{block_date} \}$

Closure of {blocker_id, blocked_id}:

$\{\text{blocker_id, blocked_id}\}^+ = \{\text{blocker_id, blocked_id, block_date}\}$

Closure of $\{\text{blocker_id, blocked_id}\}$ covers all the attributes of the Relation "BLOCKED_ACCOUNTS".

Thus $\{\text{blocker_id, blocked_id}\}$ is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {blocker_id, blocked_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "BLOCKED_ACCOUNTS" is a Super Key.

Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"CLOSE_FRIENDS_LIST" Relation:

CLOSE_FRIENDS_LIST(user_id, friend_id, added_at)

FDs:

$\{\text{user_id, friend_id}\} \rightarrow \{\text{added_at}\}$

Closure of {user_id, friend_id}:

$\{\text{user_id, friend_id}\}^+ = \{\text{user_id, friend_id, added_at}\}$

Closure of $\{\text{user_id, friend_id}\}$ covers all the attributes of the Relation "CLOSE_FRIENDS_LIST".
Thus $\{\text{user_id, friend_id}\}$ is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {user_id, friend_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "CLOSE_FRIENDS_LIST" is a Super Key.

Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"POSTS" Relation:

POSTS(post_id, caption, location_name, user_id)

FDs:

$\{post_id\} \rightarrow \{caption, location_name, user_id\}$

Closure of {post_id}:

$\{post_id\}^+ = \{post_id, caption, location_name, user_id\}$

Closure of $\{post_id\}$ covers all the attributes of the Relation "POSTS".
Thus $\{post_id\}$ is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {post_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "POSTS" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"POST_MEDIA" Relation:

POST_MEDIA(media_id, post_id, media_url, position)

FDs:

$\{media_id\} \rightarrow \{post_id, media_url, position\}$

Closure of {media_id}:

$\{media_id\}^+ = \{media_id, post_id, media_url, position\}$

Closure of $\{media_id\}$ covers all the attributes of the Relation "POST_MEDIA".
Thus $\{media_id\}$ is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {media_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "POST_MEDIA" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"COMMENTS" Relation:

COMMENTS(comment_id, content, user_id, post_id, parent_comment_id)

FDs:

$\{comment_id\} \rightarrow \{content, user_id, post_id, parent_comment_id\}$

Note: parent_comment_id is a self-referential FK to comment_id (nullable).

Closure of {comment_id}:

$\{comment_id\}^+ = \{comment_id, content, user_id, post_id, parent_comment_id\}$

Closure of {comment_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "COMMENTS".
Thus {comment_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {comment_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "COMMENTS" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"TARGET_TYPE" Relation:

TARGET_TYPE(target_type_id, target_type_name)

FDs:

$\{target_type_id\} \rightarrow \{target_type_name\}$

Closure of {target_type_id}:

$\{target_type_id\}^+ = \{target_type_id, target_type_name\}$

Closure of {target_type_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "TARGET_TYPE".
Thus {target_type_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {target_type_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "TARGET_TYPE" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"LIKES" Relation:

LIKES(like_id, user_id, target_id, target_type_id)

FDs:

$\{like_id\} \rightarrow \{user_id, target_id, target_type_id\}$
 $\{user_id, target_id, target_type_id\} \rightarrow \{like_id\}$ [UNIQUE constraint — alternate key]

Closure of {like_id}:

$\{like_id\}^+ = \{like_id, user_id, target_id, target_type_id\}$

Closure of {like_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "LIKES".
Thus {like_id} is a candidate key.

Closure of {user_id, target_id, target_type_id}:

$\{user_id, target_id, target_type_id\}^+ = \{user_id, target_id, target_type_id, like_id\}$

Closure of {user_id, target_id, target_type_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "LIKES".
Thus {user_id, target_id, target_type_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {like_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "LIKES" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"REELS" Relation:

REELS(reel_id, video_url, music_id, total_views, is_remixable, user_id)

FDs:

$\{\text{reel_id}\} \rightarrow \{\text{video_url}, \text{music_id}, \text{total_views}, \text{is_remixable}, \text{user_id}\}$

Closure of {reel_id}:

$\{\text{reel_id}\}^+ = \{\text{reel_id}, \text{video_url}, \text{music_id}, \text{total_views}, \text{is_remixable}, \text{user_id}\}$

Closure of {reel_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "REELS".
Thus {reel_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {reel_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "REELS" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"MUSIC_LIBRARY" Relation:

MUSIC_LIBRARY(music_id, audio_url, song_title, artist_name, duration_sec)

FDs:

$\{\text{music_id}\} \rightarrow \{\text{audio_url}, \text{song_title}, \text{artist_name}, \text{duration_sec}\}$

Closure of {music_id}:

$\{\text{music_id}\}^+ = \{\text{music_id}, \text{audio_url}, \text{song_title}, \text{artist_name}, \text{duration_sec}\}$

Closure of {music_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "MUSIC_LIBRARY".
Thus {music_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {music_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "MUSIC_LIBRARY" is a Super Key.

Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"STORIES" Relation:

STORIES(story_id, media_url, expires_at, audience_type_id, user_id)

FDs:

$\{story_id\} \rightarrow \{media_url, expires_at, audience_type_id, user_id\}$

Closure of {story_id}:

$\{story_id\}^+ = \{story_id, media_url, expires_at, audience_type_id, user_id\}$

Closure of {story_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "STORIES".
Thus {story_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {story_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "STORIES" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"STORY_VIEWS" Relation:

STORY_VIEWS(story_id, viewer_id, view_time)

FDs:

$\{story_id, viewer_id\} \rightarrow \{view_time\}$

Closure of {story_id, viewer_id}:

$\{story_id, viewer_id\}^+ = \{story_id, viewer_id, view_time\}$

Closure of {story_id, viewer_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "STORY_VIEWS".
Thus {story_id, viewer_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {story_id, viewer_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "STORY_VIEWS" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"AUDIENCE_TYPE" Relation:

AUDIENCE_TYPE(audience_type_id, audience_type_name)

FDs:

{audience_type_id} → {audience_type_name}

Closure of {audience_type_id}:

{audience_type_id}⁺ = {audience_type_id, audience_type_name}

Closure of {audience_type_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "AUDIENCE_TYPE".
Thus {audience_type_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {audience_type_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "AUDIENCE_TYPE" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"HIGHLIGHTS" Relation:

HIGHLIGHTS(highlight_id, name, user_id)

FDs:

$\{\text{highlight_id}\} \rightarrow \{\text{name}, \text{user_id}\}$

Closure of {highlight_id}:

$\{\text{highlight_id}\}^+ = \{\text{highlight_id}, \text{name}, \text{user_id}\}$

Closure of {highlight_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "HIGHLIGHTS".
Thus {highlight_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {highlight_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "HIGHLIGHTS" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"CHATS" Relation:

CHATS(chat_id, sender_id, receiver_id, message_content, send_at, is_read, message_type_id)

FDs:

$\{\text{chat_id}\} \rightarrow \{\text{sender_id}, \text{receiver_id}, \text{message_content}, \text{send_at}, \text{is_read}, \text{message_type_id}\}$

Closure of {chat_id}:

$\{\text{chat_id}\}^+ = \{\text{chat_id}, \text{sender_id}, \text{receiver_id}, \text{message_content}, \text{send_at}, \text{is_read}, \text{message_type_id}\}$

Closure of {chat_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "CHATS".
Thus {chat_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {chat_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "CHATS" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"MESSAGE_TYPES" Relation:

MESSAGE_TYPES(message_type_id, type_name)

FDs:

$\{message_type_id\} \rightarrow \{type_name\}$

Closure of {message_type_id}:

$\{message_type_id\}^+ = \{message_type_id, type_name\}$

Closure of {message_type_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "MESSAGE_TYPES".
Thus {message_type_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {message_type_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "MESSAGE_TYPES" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"CALLS" Relation:

CALLS(call_id, caller_id, receiver_id, started_at, duration_seconds, status, call_type_id)

FDs:

$\{call_id\} \rightarrow \{caller_id, receiver_id, started_at, duration_seconds, status, call_type_id\}$

Closure of {call_id}:

$\{call_id\}^+ = \{call_id, caller_id, receiver_id, started_at, duration_seconds, status, call_type_id\}$

Closure of {call_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "CALLS".
Thus {call_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {call_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "CALLS" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

"CALL_TYPES" Relation:

CALL_TYPES(call_type_id, type_name)

FDs:

$\{call_type_id\} \rightarrow \{type_name\}$

Closure of {call_type_id}:

$\{call_type_id\}^+ = \{call_type_id, type_name\}$

Closure of {call_type_id} covers all the attributes of the Relation "CALL_TYPES".
Thus {call_type_id} is a candidate key.

Candidate Key: {call_type_id}

Since Candidate key is the subset of Super Key

The determinant of all the functional dependencies of the relation "CALL_TYPES" is a Super Key.
Thus given relation is in **BCNF (Boyce-Codd Normal Form)**

Final Conclusion

All the 20 relations in the database satisfy the BCNF condition.
For every non-trivial functional dependency $X \rightarrow Y$, X is a superkey.
Therefore, all relations are already in BCNF, and no decomposition was required.

This is because:

- Each entity has a well-defined primary key
- Alternate keys (like email and username) are handled properly
- Relationships involving multiple entities are handled using separate relations, which avoids hidden dependencies

So overall, the database design is well-structured and normalized up to BCNF.